

First Home Buyer Checklist

Your step-by-step path from saving to settlement · Sydney & NSW

1 Know your numbers first

- ☐ Work out your real borrowing power (income, debts, living expenses)
- ☐ Check your credit score and credit report for errors
- ☐ Set a realistic price range you can comfortably repay
- ☐ Add up ALL upfront cash: deposit + stamp duty + legals + inspection + buffer

2 Your deposit & the schemes

- ☐ Choose your deposit path: 5% (First Home Guarantee), 5-15% + LMI, 20%, or guarantor
- ☐ Check First Home Guarantee eligibility (income and price caps, limited places)
- ☐ Check your NSW stamp duty exemption / concession for your price
- ☐ Check the First Home Owner Grant (generally new builds only)
- ☐ Keep a buffer for costs beyond the deposit (often 4-6% of the price)

3 Get finance-ready

- ☐ Gather payslips and tax returns (or BAS / accountant letter if self-employed)
- ☐ Collect 3-6 months of bank statements
- ☐ Have ID ready (passport or driver's licence)
- ☐ List every debt: credit cards, HECS/HELP, car, personal, buy-now-pay-later
- ☐ Get PRE-APPROVED before you start making offers

4 House hunting

- ☐ Only inspect within your budget and pre-approval
- ☐ Order a building & pest inspection before committing
- ☐ Get a strata report if it's an apartment/townhouse
- ☐ Have your conveyancer/solicitor review the contract BEFORE you sign

5 Making an offer & settling

- ☐ Negotiate or bid within your firm limit (don't get emotional)
- ☐ Understand cooling-off and the deposit required
- ☐ Turn pre-approval into formal (unconditional) loan approval
- ☐ Arrange building insurance from exchange
- ☐ Do a final inspection before settlement
- ☐ Settlement day: funds transfer and you get the keys

First Home Buyer Checklist (cont.)

Sydney & NSW · Smart Buyer Hub

6 After you buy

- ☐ Set up an offset account and/or redraw to save on interest
- ☐ Book a loan review every year so you never overpay

Want us to do the heavy lifting?

Book a free, no-obligation chat and we'll map your exact path — deposit, schemes, borrowing power and pre-approval. Call 0415 353 927 or visit smartbuyerhub.com.au/contact.html